

ANDY LYEK

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EDUCATION

Stanford University

Bachelor of Science in Engineering, Electrical Engineering & Computer Science

Relevant Coursework: CS107: Computer Systems; CS109: Probability for CS; CS152: Trust & Safety; EE108: Digital System Design

Stanford, CA

Expected June 2028

EXPERIENCE

Member of Technical Staff

June 2026 – Sept 2026

Photon

San Francisco, CA

- Own billing, payments, and carrier-registration services end-to-end in production for a platform processing 500K+ messages daily across 50,000+ customers; serve as on-call engineer and primary contact for production incidents.
- Built a billing engine on *Stripe*, including subscriptions, prepaid wallets, entitlements, and one-off invoicing and streamed billing events over *NATS JetStream*.
- Led the migration of company-wide auth from better-auth to *WorkOS*, and shipped self-service *OAuth 2.0* client management (scope discovery, secret rotation) for the public API.
- Designed the payments service as a public *Hono* BFF over an internal *Rust + ConnectRPC* microservice with self-serve KYB onboarding; wrote the design docs and presented them to enterprise partners.
- Shipped messaging features that put our *SDK* ahead of competitors on *iMessage* and *WhatsApp*, added *Discord* and *X* (Twitter) providers, and built the official *Vercel Chat* SDK adapter as a *Vercel* partner.

Software Engineer

June 2025 – June 2026

polylabs.ai

Palo Alto, CA

- Implemented social features in React and FastAPI for their educational user generated content platform which connected over 20,000 students.
- Designed and created a statistics management system in Python for their UGC platform to track analytics such as views, user interactions, and engagement metrics.
- Built a drag-and-drop AI-powered component builder for websites using React and *Next.js*, enabling dynamic UI generation and real-time preview.

Founder & Lead Video Producer

Aug 2022 – Jul 2024

Johansen Viking Production Network

Modesto, CA

- Created a photobooth application using C++ that interfaced real time video streams into a full stack photobooth application with touch screen support to ease user experience.
- Integrated *OpenCV* and *PyTorch* into the production workflow to automatically classify videos, using an algorithm that determines validity based on previous inputs.
- Secured \$100K from U.S. Department of Education through leading my production team to create professional videos and engaging within the community.

Junior Software Developer

Aug 2021 – Feb 2022

CraftiGames

Remote

- Increased revenue by 50% through player sales by implementing game designs that maximized revenue.
- Improved efficiency within the backend infrastructure through a custom remote game system built with *Java*, *MySQL*, and *gRPC*, resulting in start times decreasing by 95%.

PROJECTS

tag2me.app | AI Reasoning, Video Processing at Scale

SaaS AI Media Analysis

- Built a web platform for analyzing social media content at scale (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts) using AI to tag the content.
- Implemented a custom metadata extraction pipeline that extracted metadata such as (title, thumbnail, source) from social media platforms with inconsistent or restricted access.
- Designed a backend API using *Next.js* to support tagging, API access, and scalable content retrieval as well as integrated *Stripe* for subscription billing and payment management.

Rice Stats | Docker, Grafana, Java, InfluxDB

Data Analytics Software

- Developed a plugin for Minecraft with *Java* that allows server owners to analyze their player interactions visually.
- Deployed *Grafana* to visualize player data trends and behaviors, providing analytics to gain insight into players.

Frostless Network | Spigot API, Java, Git, UNIX, Postgres, DevOps

Game Infrastructure

- Designed, built, and deployed a custom multi-threaded Minecraft server which supported thousands of players with minimal latency.
- Focused heavily on optimization for both client and developer experience which involved using *Redis* for high availability caching and *PostgreSQL* for data persistence, reducing server load by 75%.
- Engineered a game server system which handled networking, matchmaking and player data with the use of *Kubernetes*.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, Java, Python, Rust, C/C++, SQL (Postgres), JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: React, Next.js, Node.js, Hono, Tailwind

Developer Tools: Git, Docker, Redis, NATS, gRPC/ConnectRPC, Stripe, AWS, GCP, Kubernetes

Awards: 1st place in Cyber Security Hackathon (2022); Modesto City Schools CTE Award